

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Phase 5: Project Development Phase

5.1 Development Approach

The development of the automated procurement workflow was carried out in ServiceNow using Flow Designer under Process Automation. The build process focused on translating the approved project plan into a functional, activated flow, followed by binding that flow to the Standard Laptop catalog item so that every approved request triggers automatic task creation for the Hardware team.

5.2 Flow Creation — "Standard Laptop Task"

A new flow was created in Flow Designer with the following properties and trigger configuration:

- **Flow Name:** "Standard laptop task", developed in the Global application scope.
- **Run As:** System user, ensuring the flow executes with consistent system-level privileges.
- **Trigger:** Service Catalog trigger, initiating the flow when a catalog request is submitted for the standard laptop item.

5.3 Action Configuration — Create Catalog Task

The core automation logic is implemented through the ServiceNow Core "Create Catalog Task" action, configured as follows:

- **Requested Item:** the trigger's Requested Item record is dragged and dropped into the Request Item field, auto-populating the table as Catalog Task [sc_task].
- **Short Description:** "Laptop need to Configured".
- **Description (added field value):** "Laptop need to Configured".
- **Assignment Group (added field value):** Hardware.
- **Approval (added field value):** Approved.

All remaining action properties were left at their default values. The flow was then saved and activated, transitioning the "Standard laptop task" flow from Inactive to Active state.

5.4 Flow Assignment to the Standard Laptop Catalog Item

To bind the automation to the procurement process, the activated flow was mapped to the Standard Laptop catalog item through the following steps:

- Navigated to Maintain Items under Service Catalog and opened the "Standard Laptop" record.
- Selected the Process Engine tab for the catalog item.
- Removed any existing automation entries to eliminate legacy or manual process engines.
- Added the "Standard Laptop task" flow as the sole fulfillment engine for the item and saved the record.

5.5 Development Outcome

At the conclusion of the development phase, the "Standard Laptop task" flow is active and attached to the Standard Laptop catalog item. Any Standard Laptop order placed through the Service Catalog now automatically generates a catalog task (SCTASK) with the updated short description, pre-approved status, and assignment to the Hardware group — eliminating manual task creation and routing. The completed build was handed over for end-to-end validation during the testing phase.